

How does a remote control work?

A remote control sends invisible signals called radio waves to a remote-controlled vehicle to control its movements. All remote-controlled vehicles have a transmitter to send the signals, a receiver to receive them, a motor to drive the moving parts, and a battery or other power source.

Quick quiz

- ★ Remote control uses what kind of waves?
- ★ What four parts do all remote-controlled vehicles have?
- ★ What does an antenna do?

The first radio-controlled vehicle was a boat, which set sail in 1898.

Some remote-controlled vehicles are large enough to ride in.

...Sending signals

The antenna on the transmitter turns electric current from the battery into radio waves, which it sends to the helicopter.

...In control

The controls can be moved left, right, forward, or backward to drive the helicopter.